

CONTEXT FOR ASTRA

You are my German tutor. I am Kevin, Italian, level A2-B1. My lessons are taught in English by a native German speaker (Stefanie). Today we are reviewing: **Prepositional Adverbs & Finalsätze**

Sections covered: 25. Nicos Weg, 28. Prepositional Adverbs

LESSON SUMMARY

Kevin recapped Episode 5 of Nicos Weg, focusing on Nico lying to his parents about his studies and Yara offering him a bicycle. Stefanie introduced **Finalsätze** (purpose clauses) using **um...zu** and **damit** structures, contrasting them with **weil**. A major focus was **prepositional adverbs** (da+preposition): **damit** (with that), **dabei** (at that), **dafür** (for that), **darüber** (about that), **dagegen** (against that), and positional ones like **daneben**, **davor**, **dahinter**. Kevin practiced complex subordinate clauses with multiple verbs and the **wegen** (because of) + genitive construction. Vocabulary included **eröffnen** (to open/inaugurate officially), **sich kümmern um** (to take care of), **wütend/sauer** (angry), and **schaffen** (to manage). Kevin will continue Nicos Weg next week with more speaking practice.

KEY VOCABULARY

- **wegen** — because of [A2]
- **wütend** — angry [A2]
- **sauer** — angry / sour [A2]
- **eröffnen** — to inaugurate / to open officially [B1]
- **die Eröffnung** — inauguration / opening [B1]
- **schaffen** — to manage / to make it [A2]
- **kümmern** — to take care of / to worry about [B1]
- **das Konto** — account (bank account) [A2]
- **der Kurs** — course [A2]
- **das Geschenk** — gift / present [A2]
- **das Willkommensgeschenk** — welcome gift [B1]
- **das Fahrrad** — bicycle [A1]
- **die Bank** — bank [A1]
- **der Termin** — appointment [A2]
- **das Autorennen** — car race [B1]
- **der Garten** — garden [A1]
- **damit** — with that / so that [B1]
- **dabei** — at that / thereby [B1]
- **dafür** — for that [B1]
- **darüber** — about that [B1]
- **dagegen** — against that [B1]
- **daneben** — next to that [B1]
- **davor** — in front of that [B1]

- **dahinter** — behind that [B1]
- **belügen** — to lie to someone [B1]
- **vergessen** — to forget [A2]
- **versuchen** — to try [A2]

GRAMMAR POINTS

Finalsätze with um...zu

→ Final clauses (Finalsätze) express purpose or goal. Use 'um...zu + infinitive' when the subject is the same in both clauses. The structure is: main clause + comma + um + (objects/adverbs) + zu + infinitive. The infinitive always goes at the end. This answers questions like Wozu? (For what purpose?), Wofür? (What for?), Zu welchem Zweck? (For what purpose?).

e.g. Ich muss zur Bank gehen, um ein Konto zu eröffnen. (I must go to the bank in order to open an account.)

e.g. Sie spart Geld, um sich ein neues Auto zu kaufen. (She saves money in order to buy herself a new car.)

Finalsätze with damit

→ Use 'damit' (so that) to express purpose when the subject changes between main and subordinate clauses, or when you need to specify a different subject explicitly. 'Damit' is a subordinating conjunction that sends the conjugated verb to the end of the clause. This structure is mandatory when subjects differ and answers the same questions as um...zu: Wozu?, Wofür?, Zu welchem Zweck?

e.g. Sie gibt ihm das Fahrrad, damit er schneller fahren kann. (She gives him the bike so that he can go faster.)

e.g. Ich lerne Deutsch, damit ich in Deutschland arbeiten kann. (I learn German so that I can work in Germany.)

Prepositional adverbs (da + preposition)

→ Pronominal adverbs (Pronominaladverbien) are formed by combining 'da' (there) with a preposition to refer back to things, ideas, or situations (NOT people or animals). They replace prepositional phrases with pronouns. When the preposition starts with a vowel, add 'r' for euphony (darüber, darauf). For people, always use preposition + personal pronoun (mit ihm, für sie).

e.g. Ich spreche über das Problem. → Ich spreche darüber. (I'm talking about the problem. → I'm talking about it.)

e.g. Er wartet auf die Antwort. → Er wartet darauf. (He waits for the answer. → He waits for it.)

wegen + Genitive

→ The preposition 'wegen' means 'because of' or 'due to' and requires the genitive case in standard German. Unlike 'weil' (because) which introduces a subordinate clause with a conjugated verb, 'wegen' is followed directly by a noun or noun phrase. It is used to express causality with nominal elements.

e.g. Sie sind wütend wegen des schlechten Wetters. (They are angry because of the bad weather.)

e.g. Wegen des Unfalls bin ich zu spät gekommen. (Because of the accident I arrived late.)

Infinitive constructions with zu

→ Many German verbs require 'zu + infinitive' to complete their meaning, forming infinitive clauses (Infinitivsätze). The 'zu' stands directly before the infinitive at the end of the clause. These are subordinate clauses without their own explicit subject; the subject is understood from the main clause. Common verbs include: versuchen (to try), vergessen (to forget), schaffen (to manage), vorhaben (to plan), hoffen (to hope), beginnen/anfangen (to begin), and many others.

e.g. Ich schaffe es nicht, zur Bank zu gehen. (I don't manage to go to the bank.)

e.g. Sie vergisst immer, ihre Hausaufgaben zu machen. (She always forgets to do her homework.)

USEFUL PHRASES / REDEMittel

- **Ich habe keine Ahnung** — I have no idea (*fixed expression for not knowing something*)
- **Wie spät ist es?** — What time is it? (*asking for the time*)
- **Es ist 11 Uhr** — It is 11 o'clock (*stating the time (no 'um' when stating, 'um' only for 'at' a time)*)
- **Ich arbeite als Arzt** — I work as a doctor (*'als' means 'as' when describing a role or function*)

EXERCISES TO GENERATE

1. FILL IN THE BLANK (5 sentences)

Use the key vocabulary above. Leave one word blank per sentence. Show the answer after a separator.

2. TRANSLATION DE → EN (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

3. TRANSLATION EN → DE (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

4. DIALOGUE COMPLETION (2 short dialogues, 3-4 lines)

Leave one or two lines blank. Context: everyday situations using today's grammar (*Finalsätze with um...zu*).

5. FREE WRITING PROMPT

Ask me to write 3-5 sentences in German using at least 5 words from today's vocabulary.

6. GRAMMAR DRILL (5 sentences)

Focus on: *Finalsätze with um...zu*. Show sentences with errors for me to correct.

INSTRUCTIONS

- Correct all my answers immediately with explanation in English
- Note recurring mistakes throughout the session
- Use only A2-B1 vocabulary unless I ask for more
- If I write something correct but unnatural, suggest a more native alternative
- Use 'die KI' not 'AI' when referring to artificial intelligence